

SAP & the STAR Program

Everything to know about the company and the program

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Study pack - part 1 of 8

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First: how to say the name

It is pronounced “**S-A-P**” - three separate letters, S, A, P. Never say the word “sap.” This is a genuine filter in the interview. It stands for **Systems, Applications, and Products in Data Processing** (from the original German, *Systeme, Anwendungen und Produkte in der Datenverarbeitung*).

What SAP is, in plain words

SAP is a German software company, founded in **1972**, headquartered in **Walldorf, Germany**. It is the **largest enterprise software company in the world** and the market leader in something called **ERP**.

Think of a large company - a car manufacturer, a bank, a retailer. It has to manage money (finance and accounting), people (HR and payroll), buying materials (procurement), making products (manufacturing), moving goods (supply chain), and selling (sales). Traditionally each of these ran on separate systems that did not talk to each other.

SAP's core idea: run all of these on one connected system, sharing one set of data, so the whole business works from a single source of truth. That single connected system is called an **ERP** - Enterprise Resource Planning.

The one-line version to say in the interview: "SAP makes the enterprise software that large companies use to run their entire business - finance, HR, supply chain, manufacturing, sales - on one connected platform. It's the world leader in ERP."

Why SAP is a big deal (the scale)

From SAP's own numbers, these are the kind of facts that show you did your research. You do not need all of them - remember two or three:

- Around **98% of the S&P 500** companies (the biggest US public companies) are SAP customers.
- Roughly **84% of total global commerce** touches an SAP system.
- About **93% of the automobile industry**, **88% of banking**, and **92% of healthcare equipment** revenue involves SAP customers.
- SAP's customer base spans virtually every industry - the deck showed Unilever, Mercedes, Sephora, Microsoft as examples.

Why this matters for you: it reframes the job. You have built apps for hundreds of users. At SAP you would be learning to build systems that quietly run the world's largest businesses. That is your honest "Why SAP" hook.

The key SAP technologies (know these names)

You do not need deep knowledge. You need to know **what each thing is in one or two sentences**, so that if the interviewer mentions it, you can nod intelligently and say something true.

ERP - Enterprise Resource Planning

The category SAP leads. One integrated system to manage all core business processes on shared data. SAP's flagship ERP product today is S/4HANA.

SAP S/4HANA (and S/4HANA Cloud)

SAP's **latest-generation ERP suite**. The name means "SAP Business Suite 4, built for HANA." It runs entirely on the SAP HANA database, which makes it much faster than the older generation.

- **S/4HANA Cloud** is the cloud (software-as-a-service) version - SAP hosts and runs it, customers subscribe. This is the direction SAP is pushing everyone toward.
- Your trainer specifically said to have a general idea of **S/4HANA Cloud** - so remember: *it's SAP's modern, cloud-based ERP running on the in-memory HANA database.*

SAP HANA - the in-memory database

HANA stands for **High-performance ANalytic Appliance**. It is SAP's database, and its trick is that it keeps data **in memory (RAM)** instead of only on disk, and it stores data in **columns** rather than rows.

- Keeping data in RAM makes reads and analytics extremely fast.
- It can do both **transactions** (recording business events) and **analytics** (reporting on them) on the same system at the same time.
- **Say it like this:** "HANA is SAP's in-memory database - it keeps data in RAM instead of on disk, which makes analytics and transactions very fast. S/4HANA is the ERP built on top of it."

SAP BTP - Business Technology Platform

BTP is SAP's **platform for building on top of SAP**. If a customer needs a custom app, an integration between systems, a dashboard, or an AI feature, they build it on BTP rather than modifying the core ERP. It bundles application development (including Cloud Foundry and an ABAP environment), integration tools, analytics, database (HANA Cloud), and AI services.

- **Say it like this:** "BTP is SAP's cloud platform for extending and integrating SAP - you build custom apps, integrations, and AI on it without touching the core system."

ABAP - SAP's programming language

ABAP (Advanced Business Application Programming) is SAP's own, decades-old programming language for building business logic inside SAP systems. You do not know it yet, and that is fine - it is one of the things Scholars learn. Just know it exists and what it is for.

SAP Business AI, Joule, and generative-AI workflows

Your trainer said to have a general idea of **generative-AI workflows**. Here is the honest, simple version:

- **SAP Business AI** is SAP's push to embed AI directly into business processes - not AI for its own sake, but AI that helps with real tasks like drafting a purchase order, summarising a report, or predicting supply-chain delays.
- **Joule** is SAP's **generative-AI copilot** - a chat-style assistant built into SAP applications. You ask it something in plain language ("show me overdue invoices for this supplier") and it acts across SAP for you.
- **Generative-AI workflows** at SAP means: large language models plugged into business software so that routine work can be done by describing it in natural language, with the AI grounded in the company's real business data.

Why this connects to you: you have literally built generative-AI workflows yourself. FloatChat turns plain-English questions into database queries using a language model - the exact same pattern SAP uses with Joule, just on ocean data instead of business data. If they raise generative AI, bridge to FloatChat.

A few more names you might hear

- **Fiori** - SAP's modern user-interface design system (how SAP apps look and feel).
- **RISE with SAP** - a packaged offering that helps existing customers move to S/4HANA Cloud.
- **GROW with SAP** - the equivalent for brand-new cloud-ERP customers.
- **The SAP ecosystem** - SAP does not work alone; a huge network of partners (AWS, Google Cloud, Accenture, Deloitte, Infosys, IBM, and many more) build and deliver SAP solutions. The deck's point was "the SAP ecosystem is vast." It means there is enormous demand for people who know SAP.

The STAR Program - the heart of your interview

This is the program you are actually applying to, and “**Why STAR?**” is the most important behavioural question they ask. Know this section cold.

What STAR stands for

STAR = Student Training And Rotation. It is SAP’s dual-education program: you **study and work at the same time**. (Some materials phrase it as “Student Talent And Rotation” - if the exact words come up, “Student Training and Rotation” is the safe answer, and the meaning is what matters: students, training, and rotation through teams.)

The model is a **vocational, dual-study program** - the “learn by doing real work while you study” approach that is very common in Germany, which is where SAP is from.

What the program actually is - the 2-year journey

STAR is a **2-year Scholar journey** that turns a final-year engineering student into a full-time SAP engineer with a master’s degree. The stages:

1. **Campus Recruitment** - what you are doing now (online assessment, then panel interviews).
2. **Learning Zone (as a “Scholar”)** - about **1.5 years**: an initial **training** period, then **three practical rotation phases** of roughly **6-7 months each**, working in three different teams.
3. **Conversion Review** - an assessment near the end.
4. **Conversion Zone (as an “FTE”)** - you convert to a **Full-Time Employee**.

Running across the whole two years, you earn an **M.Tech in Software Engineering from BITS Pilani**, with the **tuition fully sponsored by SAP**.

The 5 core elements

The program is described around **5 core elements** - a good thing to be able to list:

1. **Dual System** - study and work combined.
2. **Rotating Practical Phases** - rotate through different real teams.
3. **Demand Oriented** - you are trained on what the business actually needs.
4. **Quality** - structured, high-quality training and mentoring.
5. **Binding** - it builds a strong, lasting connection between you and the company.

The concrete details (campus deck)

- **Role:** Software Engineering role from day one.
- **Degree:** M.Tech Software Engineering from **BITS Pilani**, sponsored by SAP.
- **Rotations:** three different teams, roughly 7 months each, so you see multiple technologies and domains.
- **Eligibility:** final-year B.Tech / B.E. in **Computer Science or IT**; minimum **70%** in 10th and 12th; minimum **70%** cumulative through the 6th semester; **no active backlogs**.

- **Selection process:** Step 1 - online assessment; Step 2 - panel interview with **Technical, Managerial, and HR** rounds.
- **Stipend:** about **Rs 42,892.50 per month** during the first year of the program.
- **After conversion (Full-Time Employee):** about **Rs 11,15,000 per year**, plus the BITS Pilani tuition fully covered and the three cross-functional rotations.
- **Expected joining:** around **August 2027**.

What Scholars learn

The program develops you across three areas (from the “STAR Scholars - Your Learning at SAP” slide):

- **Languages:** Java, C/C++, ABAP, .NET, JavaScript, HANA, Scala, HTML5, SQL Script, Python.
- **Technologies:** AI/ML, SAP BTP, Cloud Foundry, Android, SAP HANA, iOS, OpenStack, Docker & Kubernetes.
- **Domains:** business applications, healthcare, analytics, mobile development, machine learning, big data and storage, security, distributed computing.
- **Professional skills:** learning agility, complex problem-solving, creative thinking, effective communication, collaboration.

Notice how much of this you already touch: JavaScript, Python, C++, AI/ML, Docker, mobile development, healthcare (DokLink!), analytics (FloatChat!), security. You are not a blank slate walking in - you already speak a lot of this language. Say that.

Scholar benefits and life

Beyond pay and the degree, the program includes pre-onboarding engagement, OpenSAP courses, mentoring and coaching, innovation events (hackathons, InVent, SAP Innovation Day, D-Shop), health and wellness facilities, meals and transport, flexible working, and communities like Toastmasters. It is designed as a complete early-career launchpad, not just a job.

STAR is global

SAP runs the STAR program in many countries - Ireland, Germany, Switzerland, Portugal, India, China, Japan, Korea, Vietnam, Singapore, Indonesia, Australia/New Zealand, and more. It is an established, worldwide program, not a one-off. Mentioning that you know it is a global program shows real research.

“Why STAR?” - the model answer

They will ask this. Show **passion and genuine interest** - the trainer stressed this repeatedly. Make it personal and true, in your own words:

“Honestly, the STAR program feels like it was designed for exactly how I learn. I’ve taught myself most of what I know by building real things - shipping an app, running a server, fixing it when it breaks. STAR is that same idea, but structured and at a scale I could never reach on my own: I’d be doing real engineering work in real teams, rotating through three of them so I see different technologies and domains, and at the same time earning an M.Tech from BITS Pilani that SAP fully sponsors.

What really pulls me in is the rotations. Right now I work mostly alone on my own projects, so the chance to work inside three different teams, on enterprise systems, with mentors, is exactly the growth I want. And it’s not a short internship - it’s a two-year journey that turns you into a real SAP engineer. For someone who genuinely loves building software and wants to go deep, I can’t think of a better start to a career. That’s why I want this, specifically, and not just any job.”

Why it works: it ties the program’s real features (rotations, M.Tech, dual model, two-year depth) to your genuine self (self-taught builder who wants team experience), and it radiates enthusiasm without sounding scripted. Deliver it like you mean it, because you do.

Full-forms and short-questions glossary

They love asking for full forms. Here are the ones most likely to come up. Learn the SAP ones and the CS ones on your resume.

SAP / program terms

Short form	Full form
SAP	Systems, Applications, and Products in Data Processing
STAR	Student Training And Rotation
ERP	Enterprise Resource Planning
HANA	High-performance ANalytic Appliance
BTP	Business Technology Platform
S/4HANA	SAP Business Suite 4 HANA
ABAP	Advanced Business Application Programming
FTE	Full-Time Employee
CTC	Cost To Company

Computer-science terms on your resume

Short form	Full form
API	Application Programming Interface
REST	Representational State Transfer
JWT	JSON Web Token
OTP	One-Time Password
HMAC	Hash-based Message Authentication Code
SHA	Secure Hash Algorithm
ACID	Atomicity, Consistency, Isolation, Durability
SQL	Structured Query Language
CRUD	Create, Read, Update, Delete
DBMS	Database Management System
RDBMS	Relational Database Management System
CI/CD	Continuous Integration / Continuous Deployment
RAG	Retrieval-Augmented Generation
ETL	Extract, Transform, Load
LLM	Large Language Model
NLP	Natural Language Processing
PWA	Progressive Web App
XSS	Cross-Site Scripting
CSRF	Cross-Site Request Forgery
SSL / TLS	Secure Sockets Layer / Transport Layer Security
DNS	Domain Name System
VPS	Virtual Private Server

Short form	Full form
JSON	JavaScript Object Notation
OOP	Object-Oriented Programming
SDK	Software Development Kit
DRF	Django REST Framework

Research-paper terms (in case they ask)

Short form	Full form
AV	Autonomous Vehicle
eHMI	External Human-Machine Interface
XR	Extended Reality
VR	Virtual Reality
SUS	System Usability Scale
NASA-TLX	NASA Task Load Index

The one-paragraph summary to carry in

If you remember nothing else about the company: *SAP is the German company that makes the world's leading enterprise software - ERP systems that run the finance, HR, supply chain, and operations of most of the world's largest businesses. Its modern products run on the in-memory HANA database (S/4HANA), it is moving everything to the cloud (S/4HANA Cloud), it builds on the BTP platform, and it is embedding generative AI into business processes through Joule. The STAR program is its 2-year dual-study program where I'd work as an engineer across three team rotations while earning a sponsored M.Tech from BITS Pilani.*